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Personally transformative choices L.A. Paul 2015b; 2015a ## Introduction

Practical knowledge is narratively-inflected knowledge.

Proceeding when faced with personally transformative choices. We need skillful transformative decision-making, but may only be capable of unskillful transformative decision-making.

This is because

Personally transformative choices cannot be tracked in rational decision problems.

Rust argues that this is because: “we skillfully navigate our personally transformative choices to the extent that those decisions are, not prudentially intelligible, but narratively intelligible to ourselves and others.”

1. skillfully made transformative decisions are narratively intelligible decisions
2. narrative intelligibility: stories prototypically explicate a character’s personally transformative experiences in terms of the movement or development of intersubjectively appreciable emotional cadences. In other words, a narratively-inflected affectual sequence by which someone comes to convincingly adopt a new and incompatible set of desires and goals. (74) ” According to his own telling, Hawkins had been living an instrumentally optimized life: a programmer who secured employment at his ideal workplace Google, while living in his dream city, San Francisco, Hawkins used recommendation software to drink the best coffee, eat at the best restaurants, and attend the best clubs and bars” but found himself questioning whether this was truly him. What is missing is the “emotional trajectory that helps . . . understand how . . . came to want to be”. The emotional trajectory that explains a persons motivations and desires.
3. How an agent might fail to make narratively intelligible transformative choices
 1. No emotional engagement, not emotionally convincing, e.g., Nikolai Rostov choosing to join the Russian army being a product of youthful exuberance.
 2. Responding to demands of the moment rather than creating plots in response to encounters.